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About the Author

Robert Wilson Lynd (1879 – 1949), an Irish writer, is one of the greatest essayists of the 20th Century. He began his career as a journalist. He penned numerous articles for the leading newspapers and magazines like Daily News, The New Statesman and Nation. He wrote under the pseudonym 'Y.Y.' His essays cover a wide range of simple and interesting topics. They are humorous, delightful, ironical and satirical. Robert Lynd was awarded with an honorary literary Doctorate by Queen's University, Belfast in 1947. He was also honoured by the Royal Society of Literature with a silver medal and by The Sunday Times with a gold medal for *Belles Lettres*. In his essay '*Forgetting*', Robert Lynd takes a humourous look at the nature and effects of forgetfulness.

Glossary

vintage - wine of high quality produced in a particular year

antipathy - strong dislike

fortunes - huge sums of money

reluctant - unwilling

delinquent - a young person who is regularly involved in wrongdoing

exploits - daring or heroic acts or actions, feats

abstracted - lacking concentration on what is happening around

prosaic - dull

mediocre - not very good, ordinary

fallible - capable of making mistakes

sieve - strainer or filter

audacious - bold and daring

eccentric - tending to act strangely

indignant - being very angry

quivering - trembling, shivering

vexation - irritation, annoyance

1. Based on your understanding of the essay, answer the following questions in one or two sentences each.

a) What does Lynd actually wonder at?

b) Name a few things that a person remembers easily.

c) How do psychologists interpret forgetfulness?

d) What is the commonest type of forgetfulness, according to Lynd?

e) What does the author mean when he says the letter in his pocket leads an unadventurous life?

f) What are the articles the writer forgets most often?

g) Who are the citizens of 'dreamland'? Why?

h) What is common about the 'angler' and the 'poet'?